

Corvina Hartwell

Character Dossier

Patient as stone translator of the Frostwall garrison on the northern border

Overview

Corvina Hartwell is a translator living in the Frostwall garrison on the northern border. Corvina is 49 years old, originally from the Mirefold, and is known around the east rampart as patient as stone. In conversation Corvina switches to formal speech when angry.

Background

Corvina arrived in the Frostwall garrison on the northern border 4 years ago after leaving the Mirefold under circumstances Corvina describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Frostwall Legion; the second was the one that stuck. Today Corvina works as a translator near the quartermaster's stores and is paid, when paid at all, in iron pennies.

Corvina learned the trade from Vesna Corvane, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Corvina's life is with Pilar Lindqvist, over a matter neither will explain. The person Corvina trusts most is Wilhelmina Duskmere.

Current goal: to earn the title of master before turning fifty. Greatest fear: a knock at the door after dark.

Personality and speech

Temperament: patient as stone.

Speech pattern: Corvina switches to formal speech when angry.

Tells: when lying, Corvina mentions Dumpling the tortoise for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Corvina Hartwell
Role	translator
Home	the Frostwall garrison on the northern border
Hometown	the Mirefold
Age	49
Favourite dish	grandmother's mushroom dumplings
Pet	Dumpling, a tortoise
Lucky number	535

<i>Workshop password</i>	tide-fern
<i>Mentor</i>	Vesna Corvane
<i>Rival</i>	Pilar Lindqvist
<i>Closest friend</i>	Wilhelmina Duskmere

Secret

Corvina owes Pilar Lindqvist a debt of 178 iron pennies that neither of them mentions.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Corvina: I am the translator. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Corvina: Grandmother's mushroom dumplings. Do not tell Pilar I said so.

Visitor: Is Dumpling yours?

Corvina: Dumpling belongs to nobody. Dumpling tolerates me. Lucky number is 535, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, spring of year 31

Corvina was hired to carry a sextant from the east rampart to the mess hall without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Caspian came by asking about the new curfew. Corvina said nothing useful and made tea instead. Sixten came by asking about the tax on doors. Corvina said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 2, summer of year 31

The weather turned. Corvina moved the pair of spectacles indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about who really won the regatta. Rumours about the missing shipment reached the mess hall. Corvina pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Corvina closed early, walked to the east rampart, and watched the lights come on. Corvina closed early, walked to the east rampart, and watched the lights come on.

Entry 3, winter of year 31

Corvina found a iron kettle half-buried near the east rampart and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Someone left a hand bell on the doorstep with no note. Corvina has a suspect and is probably right. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the price of lamp oil for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 4, winter of year 31

The weather turned. Corvina moved the tin whistle indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the quarantine. Someone left a cracked compass on the doorstep with no note. Corvina has a suspect and is probably right. Corvina closed early, walked to the frozen moat, and watched the lights come on.

Entry 5, spring of year 32

Petra came by asking about the old tunnels. Corvina said nothing useful and made tea instead. The weather turned. Corvina moved the brass lantern indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about whether the bridge will hold. A stranger asked Corvina for the password to the workshop. Corvina laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 6, autumn of year 32

Rumours about the census reached the frozen moat. Corvina pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Rumours about the quarantine reached the frozen moat. Corvina pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Corvina was hired to carry a spool of wire from the frozen moat to the quartermaster's stores without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A dispute over the comet flared up between Corvina and a neighbour outside the frozen moat; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 7, winter of year 32

The weather turned. Corvina moved the iron kettle indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the new curfew. Rumours about whether the bridge will hold reached the frozen moat. Corvina pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Corvina spent the day counting stock at the frozen moat: 20 of everything, except the sextant, which is always short.

Entry 8, spring of year 32

Corvina repaired the tin whistle at the mess hall for Yannick, who paid in 85 iron pennies and a long story about who really won the regatta. Yusuf came by asking about the harvest count. Corvina said nothing useful and made tea instead. Corvina closed early, walked to the frozen moat, and watched the lights come on. Corvina found a grain scale half-buried near the mess hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Corvina repaired the wax seal at the mess hall for Nikolai, who paid in 15 iron pennies and a long story about whether the bridge will hold.

Entry 9, autumn of year 33

Corvina found a hand bell half-buried near the east rampart and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Corvina spent the day counting stock at the east rampart: 70 of everything, except the iron kettle, which is always short. Corvina closed early, walked to the frozen moat, and watched the lights come on. A dispute over the singing at the docks flared up between Corvina and a neighbour outside the east rampart; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the comet. Corvina read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 10, winter of year 33

Dashiell came by asking about the missing shipment. Corvina said nothing useful and made tea instead. Someone left a clockwork bird on the doorstep with no note. Corvina has a suspect and is probably right. At the east rampart, Corvina taught a newcomer how to tell a real clockwork bird from a fake one by weight alone. Corvina closed early, walked to the frozen moat, and watched the lights come on.

Entry 11, spring of year 33

Corvina closed early, walked to the quartermaster's stores, and watched the lights come on. Corvina found a clockwork bird half-buried near the mess hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Someone left a cracked compass on the doorstep with no note. Corvina has a suspect and is probably right. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the tariff on salt for an hour and parted better friends than before. Corvina spent the day counting stock at the mess hall: 11 of everything, except the grain scale, which is always short.